29

29 Podiatrist

Podiatrists are enrolled only for services provided to QMB recipients or to recipients referred as a result of an EPSDT screening.

Podiatrist services are available for up to 30 days prior to release for an eligible child under the age 21 being held “post adjudication” as an inmate of a public institution. Adjudication is the court process that determines if an individual committed the act for which they were charged.

The policy provisions for podiatrists can be found in the *Alabama Medicaid Agency Administrative Code*, Chapter 11.

29.1 Enrollment

Alabama Medicaid’s Fiscal Agent enrolls podiatrists and issues provider contracts to applicants who meet the licensure and/or certification requirements of the state of Alabama, the Code of Federal Regulations, the *Alabama Medicaid Agency Administrative Code*, and the *Alabama Medicaid Provider Manual*.

Federal requirements mandate providers re-validate periodically with the Alabama Medicaid program. Providers will be notified when they are scheduled to re-validate. Failure to re-validate and provide appropriate documentation to complete enrollment will result in an end-date being placed on the provider file. Once a provider file has been closed for failure to timely re-validate, providers will have to submit a new application for enrollment.

Refer to Chapter 2, Becoming a Medicaid Provider, for general enrollment instructions and information. Failure to provide accurate and truthful information or intentional misrepresentation might result in action ranging from denial of application to permanent exclusion.

National Provider Identifier, Type, and Specialty

A provider who contracts with Alabama Medicaid as a podiatrist provider is added to the Medicaid system with the National Provider Identifiers provided at the time applications is made. Appropriate provider specialty codes are assigned to enable the provider to submit requests and receive reimbursements for podiatry-related claims.

NOTE:
The 10-digit NPI is required when filing a claim.

Podiatrists are assigned a provider type of 14 (Podiatrist). Valid specialties for podiatrists include the following:

- Podiatry (140)
- QMB/EPSDT (600)

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Enrollment Policy for Podiatrists

To participate in the Alabama Medicaid Program, podiatrists must meet the following requirements:

- Possess a current license issued to practice podiatry
- Operate within the scope of practice established by the appropriate state's Board of Podiatry

29.2 Benefits and Limitations

This section describes program-specific benefits and limitations. Refer to Chapter 3, Verifying Recipient Eligibility, for general benefit information and limitations. Refer to Chapter 7, Understanding Your Rights and Responsibilities as a Provider, for general criteria on Medical Necessity/ Medically Necessary Care.

Podiatry services are covered for services provided to QMB recipients, for recipients referred as a result of an EPSDT screening, or up to 30 days prior to release for an eligible child under the age 21 being held “post adjudication” as an inmate of a public institution.

For more information regarding the EPSDT program, refer to Appendix A, EPSDT.

29.3 Prior Authorization and Referral Requirements

Podiatrist may provide services for QMB recipients or to recipients as a result of an EPSDT screening. Podiatrist services are also available for up to 30 days prior to release for an eligible child under the age of 21 being held “post adjudication” as an inmate of a public institution.

For podiatry services to be paid by Medicaid for non-QMB recipients (i.e., EPSDT), the service must be medically necessary and the result of a referral from a contracted Medicaid EPSDT screening provider. Screening providers will complete and forward an Agency Referral Form (form 362), which must identify the reason for referral and serve as documentation that the services provided were the result of an EPSDT screening.

Signature Requirement for Referrals: Effective May 16, 2012:
For hard copy referrals, the printed, typed, or stamped name of the primary care physician with an original signature of the physician or designee is required. **Stamped or copied signatures will not be accepted**. For electronic referrals, provider certification is made via standardized electronic signature protocol.

When filing claims for recipients enrolled in the Alabama Coordinated Health Network (ACHN) Program, refer to Chapter 40 to determine whether your services require a referral from the Primary Care Physician (PCP).

29.4 Cost Sharing (Copayment)

The copayment amount for office visit* including crossovers is:

$3.90 for procedure codes reimbursed $50.01 and greater
$2.60 for procedure codes reimbursed between $25.01 and $50.00
$1.30 for procedure codes reimbursed between $10.01 and $25.00

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* The following CPT codes are considered office visits and the copayment is based on Medicaid's allowed amount (fee schedule) for each procedure:

99202, 99203, 99204, 99205, 99211, 99212, 99213, 99214, 99215, 99241, 99242, 99243, 99244, 99245,
If one of these CPT codes is applicable for your practice, then copay applies.

Copayment does not apply to services provided for pregnant women, nursing facility residents, recipients less than 18 years of age, emergencies, and family planning. Native American Indians that present an "active user letter" issued by Indian Health Services (IHS) will be exempt from the Medicaid required copayment.

The provider may not deny services to any eligible Medicaid recipient because of the recipient's inability to pay the cost-sharing (copayment) amount imposed.

29.5 Completing the Claim Form

To enhance the effectiveness and efficiency of Medicaid processing, providers should bill Medicaid claims electronically.

Podiatrists who bill Medicaid claims electronically receive the following benefits:

- Quicker claim processing turnaround
- Immediate claim correction
- Enhanced online adjustment functions
- Improved access to eligibility information

Refer to Appendix B, Electronic Media Claims Guidelines, for more information about electronic filing.

NOTE:

When filing a claim on paper, a CMS-1500 claim form is required. Medicare-related claims must be filed using the Medical Medicaid/Medicare-related Claim Form.

This section describes program-specific claims information. Refer to Chapter 5, Filing Claims, for general claims filing information and instructions.

29.5.1 Time Limit for Filing Claims

Medicaid requires all claims for podiatrists to be filed within one year of the date of service. Refer to Section 5.1.4, Filing Limits, for more information regarding timely filing limits and exceptions.

29.5.2 Diagnosis Codes

The *International Classification of Diseases - 10th Revision - Clinical Modification* (ICD-10-CM) manual lists required diagnosis codes. These manuals may be obtained by contacting the American Medical Association, AMA Plaza 330 North Wabash Ave, Suite 39300 Chicago, IL 60611-5885, or 1-800-621-8335.

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NOTE:

ICD-10 codes should be used for claims submitted with dates of service on/after 10/01/2015.

NOTE:

ICD-9 or ICD-10 diagnosis codes must be listed to the highest number of digits possible (3, 4, or 5 digits). Do not use decimal points in the diagnosis code field.

29.5.3 Procedure Codes and Modifiers

Podiatry providers use the Current Procedural Terminology (CPT) coding system. The CPT manual lists most required procedure codes. This manual may be obtained by contacting the Order Department, American Medical Association, 515 North State Street, Chicago, IL 60610-9986.

The (837) Professional electronic claim and the paper claim have been modified to accept up to four Procedure Code Modifiers.

Podiatry CPT codes describing procedures performed on the foot and toes range from 28001 - 29909. In addition to the 28001-29909 CPT codes, podiatrists may also use the evaluation and management codes 99202-99215 and nail codes 11719-11765. Procedure code coverage, maximum units and prior authorization requirements should be checked through AVRS prior to rendering service. Refer to Appendix L, AVRS Quick Reference Guide, for more details on verifying this information.

29.5.4 Place of Service Codes

The following place of service codes apply when filing claims for podiatry services:

POS Code	*Description*
11	Office
21	Inpatient Hospital
22	Outpatient Hospital
23	Emergency Room – Hospital
24	Ambulatory Surgical Center
31	Skilled Nursing Facility or Nursing Home
32	Nursing Facility
51	Inpatient Psychiatric Facility
52	Psychiatric Facility Partial Hospitalization
54	Intermediate Care Facility/Mentally Retarded
61	Comprehensive Inpatient Rehabilitation Facility
62	Comprehensive Outpatient Rehabilitation Facility
71	State or Local Public Health Clinic
72	Rural Health Clinic

29.5.5 Required Attachments

To enhance the effectiveness and efficiency of Medicaid processing, your attachments should be limited to the following circumstances:

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- Claims With Third Party Denials

NOTE:
When an attachment is required, a hard copy CMS-1500 claim form must be submitted.

Refer to Section 5.8, Required Attachments, for more information on attachments.

29.6 For More Information

This section contains a cross-reference to other relevant sections in the manual.

Resource	Where to Find It
CMS-1500 Claim Filing Instructions	Chapter 5
Medical Medicaid/Medicare-related Claim Filing Instructions	Chapter 5
Medical Necessity/Medically Necessary Care	Chapter 7
Electronic Media Claims (EMC) Submission Guidelines	Appendix B
AVRS Quick Reference Guide	Appendix L
Alabama Medicaid Contact Information	Appendix N

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